

PRINCIPLES OF MACROECONOMICS (ECON 051)

Fall 2026

Instructor: Marisa Cameron
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Section	Time	Location
ECON051 PO-03	TR 08:10-09:25AM	Carnegie 214
ECON051 PO-04	TR 09:35-10:50AM	Carnegie 107
ECON051 PO-05	TR 01:15-02:30PM	Estella 1249

Welcome!

Inclusive teaching is intentional and reflective. Inclusive teaching builds community, is student-centered, acknowledges the whole student, and is accessible to all students. Inclusive teaching develops critical and creative thinkers who positively contribute to our community.

This definition of inclusive teaching was developed by Pomona faculty over the past few years, and it is what I aim to practice in our classroom.

How to contact me:

Email: marisa.cameron@pomona.edu

Office hours: Tuesday 3:00-4:00PM, Wednesday 2:00-3:00PM, Thursday 3:00-4:00PM in Carnegie 201 and by appointment through [Calendly](#).

Note: Monday is my research day, in which I do not have any meetings. I will do my best to respond promptly to emails, but I like to have a balanced life. Please trust that I will get back to you as soon as possible, usually within 24 hours on weekdays.

Introduction

In this course we will introduce some basic analytical tools in economics. The class will focus on understanding economic issues regarding national output, unemployment, inflation, business fluctuations, and price level. We will also get familiar with economic performance measures, the financial sector, stabilization policies, economic growth, and international economics.

Learning goals:

- To learn foundations of microeconomic and macroeconomic theories
- To learn the principles of macroeconomics in relation to measuring national economic goals of economic growth, full employment and price-level stability
- Learn to use graphs, charts, and data to analyze, describe, and explain economic concepts.
- Learn how to speak and write clearly about macroeconomic issues

Course Materials:

- **Textbook:** We will utilize CORE Econ's *The Economy 2.0 Macroeconomics*. This textbook is open sourced and free for you to access.

- **iClicker:** Create your iClicker account using your student email. Details about iClicker grading are posted on Canvas. You will be provided with a designated iClicker remote at the beginning of each class.

Grading Distribution:

Exam 1	20%
Exam 2	20%
Exam 3	20%
Blue Book Questions	24%
iClicker Participation	8%
Fact Checker Activities	8%

A	94-100	B-	79-81.9	D+	66-68.9
A-	90-93.9	C+	75-78.9	D	63-65.9
B+	86-89.9	C	72-74.9	D-	60-62.9
B	82-85.9	C-	69-71.9	F	59 or below

Assignments and Grading

Exams: There will be three exams throughout the semester. They will be taken in class during our normal class period. There will not be a final exam in this course. Exam 3 is not cumulative and will be taken on the last day of class prior to reading days.

Blue Book Questions: Each week, six questions based on the previous week's material will be posted on Canvas. You'll have a week to review them before one is randomly selected for you to answer in class the following Tuesday. *For example: questions released Tuesday, September 1st would be answered in class on Tuesday, September 8th.*

Throughout the semester, you will complete 11 blue book questions in class. Your lowest 3 scores will automatically be dropped, so only your top 8 count towards your final grade, each worth 3%. This built-in drop is meant to cover any Tuesdays you need to miss, so there will be no makeup blue book questions. You will have ten minutes to complete the blue book question in class.

Clicker Check-Ins: Clicker check-ins will consist of a couple of questions and will be asked throughout the class. The purpose of clicker check-ins is to gauge how you grasp the material. There will be two types of Clicker questions, knowledge-based questions and general survey questions.

1. **Knowledge-based questions:** These questions consist of material we have already covered that I expect you to know the answer to. They are worth two points. One point for attempting the question and one point for answering correctly.
2. **Survey questions:** These questions do not require additional context and are worth one point simply for answering the question.

The Clicker grading format is designed so that you can miss 3-4 classes throughout the semester without being penalized. These absences include University-excused absences. If you think you will exceed more than 3-4 excused absences throughout the semester please set up a time to meet with me.

Fact Checker Activity: Once a week, starting the second week of the semester, a fact checking activity will be completed in class. Throughout the semester we will complete at least 10 fact checking activities, only your top 8 scores will count towards your final grade, each worth 1%. Additional details about the structure and expectations of this activity are posted on Canvas.

Resources:

Mentor Sessions:

We are fortunate to have three mentors for this course. Our mentors this semester are Jai Swarup, Juan Florido, and Aidan McGreen. Mentor sessions will begin the second week of the semester. If you can't make these sessions or office hours, let me know please, and we will arrange something.

- **Jai Swarup:** Tuesday's 2:45-4:45, Carnegie 109
- **Juan Florido:** Friday's 6:00-8:00, Carnegie 109
- **Aidan McGreen:** Wednesday's 7:00-9:00, Carnegie 214

AI Policy:

I recognize the value of using AI to get feedback or check your work outside of class. During lecture, however, this class is technology-free: unless stated otherwise, phones and laptops should not be in use. Notes may be taken on an iPad lying flat on your desk, or by hand.

All graded components of this course take place in person, during class time, so your engagement with the material outside of class is what will prepare you to succeed on them. AI literacy matters, and we will discuss in class how to use AI to support your learning in this course, while still making sure you build the critical thinking skills you'll need in future classes and life.

Pomona College is committed to helping every student to succeed and thrive. Below are a few of the specific academic offices, wellness programs, and peer-mentoring or connecting resources available to you.

Center for Speaking, Writing, and the Image (CSWIM):

The Center for Speaking, Writing, and the Image (CSWIM) offers free, one-on-one consultations with CSWIM Partners to all students enrolled in Pomona College courses. CSWIM Partners are peer mentors who talk with students about writing, speaking, and multimodal communication projects and provide feedback at any stage, from brainstorming to outlining to preparing a final draft. CSWIM Partners are trained to think deeply about communication, helping with everything from ID1 papers and lab reports to presentations and senior theses. They can also help students develop strategies for reading across genres and engaging more confidently in class discussion. The CSWIM is open for pre-scheduled and drop-in consultations Sunday–Friday in Smith Campus Center 148. To schedule an appointment, please visit <https://pomona.mywconline.com/>. Students can also request to be paired with a regular CSWIM Partner for weekly appointments over the course of the semester. Contact the CSWIM with questions at cswim@pomona.edu.

Quantitative Skills Center (QSC)

The Quantitative Skills Center (QSC) provides academic support to Pomona College students in courses that feature a large degree of quantitative and/or scientific reasoning through our QSC Partners Program. QSC partners meet one-on-one with students to provide support for a variety of Pomona courses for course specific help. The QSC also offers non-course specific help in general quantitative skills and offers consultations for projects and theses involving quantitative methods. Additionally, Dylan Worcester, Director of the QSC, and Angel Bradley, Assistant Director of the QSC are available to meet with you regarding your success in STEM at Pomona College. To make an appointment at the QSC, please visit pomona.mywconline.com or contact us at qsc@pomona.edu. The QSC is located in SCC (Smith Campus Center) 228.

Sage Fellows:

The Sage Fellows Program offers peer academic coaches to help Pomona students become more effective and efficient learners. This program offers individual coaching, weekly drop-in office hours (no appointment required), and workshops designed to help students achieve academic success. Sage Fellows can assist students with time management; organization; study habits and strategies; reading and note-taking skills; motivation and procrastination; stress management and wellness strategies; and more fully accessing campus resources. For more information or to get connected to a Sage Fellow, please email studentaffairs@pomona.edu.

Accessibility Resources and Services (ARS):

Pomona College is committed to the fair and equitable treatment of all members of our community. This includes providing and improving accessibility for everyone at Pomona College. Consistent with the open

community of Pomona, this includes people with specific needs or disabilities. We encourage you to have a conversation with your instructors, coaches, mentors, and others on campus who can help you access what you need to succeed. See this [link](#) for a non-exhaustive list of accommodations. For specific academic accommodations, students need to submit documentation with the ARS office and engage in an interactive process to determine which accommodation(s) may be appropriate. For more information, please reach out to disability@pomona.edu. See this [step-by-step guide](#) to the accommodations process and ways that you can be supported. Additionally, students can receive additional assistance and resources from the [7C Student Disability Resource Center \(SDRC\)](#). The SDRC hosts events, loans assistive technology, and offers student accommodation support.

Mental Health and Wellness Resources:

[Monsour Counseling and Psychological Services \(MCAPS\)](#) is the mental health resource to the five undergraduate institutions of The Claremont Colleges. Their professional staff serves all enrolled undergraduates and provides in-person counseling. There are no fees for counseling services and all services are confidential. In addition, [TimelyCare](#) provides 24/7 access to on-demand medical care and “Talk Now” mental health support, along with links to short videos that support mental and physical wellbeing. If a student needs immediate support, they can contact MCAPS Crisis Line 24/7: 909-621-8202 and select option 1. The [Wellness Resources](#) page contains additional information about mental, physical, and other student support services.

Title IX makes it clear that violence and harassment based on sex and gender are Civil Rights offenses subject to the same kinds of accountability and the same kinds of support applied to offenses against other protected categories such as race, national origin, etc. If you or someone you know has been harassed or assaulted, you can find the appropriate resources at <http://7csexualmisconductresources.claremont.edu>.

Tentative Course Outline:

Date	Topic	Chapter
Sept. 1 & 3	Introductory Material	N/A
Sept. 8 & 9	The supply side of the macroeconomy: Unemployment and real wages	1
Sept. 15 & 16	Unemployment, wages, and inequality: Supply-side policies and institutions	2
Sept. 22 & 24	Aggregate demand and the multiplier model	3
Sept. 29	Exam Review	
Oct. 1	Exam 1	1, 2, 3
Oct. 6 & 8	Inflation and unemployment	4
Oct. 13, 15, 22	Macroeconomic policy: Inflation and unemployment	5
Oct. 27 & 29	The financial sector: Debt, money, and financial markets	6
Nov. 3	Exam Review	
Nov. 5	Exam 2	4, 5, 6
Nov. 10 & 12	Macroeconomic policy in the global economy	7
Nov. 17	Economic dynamics: Financial and environmental crises	8
Nov. 19	Uneven development on a global scale	9
Nov. 24 & Dec. 1	Government as economic actor: Economics, politics, and public policy	10
Dec. 3	Exam Review	
Dec. 8	Exam 3	7, 8, 9, 10

Important Dates:

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Exam 1	October 1
Exam 2	November 5
Exam 3	December 8

Subject to Change Statement:

Information contained in the course syllabus may be subject to change with notice.